Lesson notes · for you

AI makes guesses

AI security · Primary school · Lesson 1

Time
20 min

Materials
Your school book; Paper and a pencil; Five facts to read out: some true, some made up

Learning goals

- Explain that AI learns from examples and makes guesses.
- Say why a sure answer can still be wrong.
- Check an answer with a book or a grown-up.

Activity: Robot or right?

1. Warm-up (3 min): Think of an app, a game or a toy that talks to you or answers you. Does it ever get things wrong?
2. Write (7 min): Write five facts from your school subjects. Make three true and two made up, and write all five so they sound very sure.
3. Play (7 min): Read your facts to a partner or your family in a sure robot voice. For each one they say “true”, “false” or “let's check”.
4. Check (3 min): Check every fact together in your school book. Which made-up fact sounded most true?

No device needed. Use your school book to check the facts.

Discussion

- Why can a computer that learned from examples still be wrong?
- Which answers should you always check?
- Who can help you check at home?

Check yourself

- Write one answer you would always check, and how you would check it.

Try it this week
Play “Robot or right?” at home: someone reads out facts in a very sure voice, some true and some made up. Everyone says “true”, “false” or “let's check”, and then you check together in a book.

Worksheet

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Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

1 **A chatbot says a plant in the school garden is safe to eat. What do you do?**

◯ Ask the chatbot again ◯ Eat it: the chatbot said so ◯ Ask a grown-up first

2 **Which of these learns from examples and makes guesses?**

◯ A lamp ◯ A chatbot ◯ A calculator

3 **If a chatbot sounds very sure, its answer must be right.**

◯ True ◯ False

4 **Put in order: what to do when an AI answer matters.**

☐ Check a book or ask a grown-up

☐ Use it only if it's right

☐ Read the answer

☐ Ask yourself: does this matter?

5 **Match each AI answer to what you do.**

A funny poem about a cat	• • • •	Check your school book
How to clean a cut on your knee	• • • •	Just enjoy it
The capital of Kenya, for homework	• • • •	Ask a grown-up

✎ **Think of a time a computer, a game or an app got something wrong. How did you find out?**

Check your answers

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1 **Ask a grown-up first**

Anything about your health or safety needs a grown-up to check.

2 **A chatbot**

A chatbot learned from millions of sentences and guesses its answers.

3 **False**

A chatbot doesn't feel unsure, so it sounds just as sure when it is wrong.

4 **Top to bottom: 3, 4, 1, 2**

First read it, then decide if it matters.

5 **A funny poem about a cat — Just enjoy it**
How to clean a cut on your knee — Ask a grown-up
The capital of Kenya, for homework — Check your school book

A poem is just for fun. Your health needs a grown-up.